Emmanuel Bakopoulos.

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Founder of v2byVELARE, a streetwear brand I started at 16, now running at $1.2M+ a year and up 30% year over year. I run the whole business, from product and manufacturing to ads and cash, and taught myself to write the software I run it on. Finished high school in June 2026 and chose to build full time before college.

experience

Founder, v2byVELARE (Velare LLC)

June 2025 – Present

- $1.35M in sales and 15,400+ orders since June 2025, fully bootstrapped. $138K in the first full month, best month $213K and 2,500+ orders (Dec 2025)
- Run the full operation: product design, overseas manufacturing ($240K+ in production in 2026), paid ads, SMS, fulfillment, cash and a 3 person contract team
- Built an 89K follower Instagram and 16K SMS list, mostly organic, that power limited drops. Best day $45K
- Directed $195K+ in Meta ads with an outside agency, holding ~5x revenue per ad dollar in scale months

Head of Growth & Marketing, QuantMap

Oct 2026 – Present

Quant analytics platform that maps key price levels on CME futures, crypto and 10K+ US stocks before the open, graded at the close. Seen in Forbes, Business Insider, Yahoo Finance and Investopedia.

- Brought in by the founders to own growth end to end: paid acquisition, funnel, tracking, content strategy and the sales team (hiring, scripts and pay for setters and closers)
- Wrote the go-to-market roadmap in my first two weeks: audited the site, track record and payment risk, mapped 22 competitors, and redesigned the funnel around a live trader-led demo that closes on the call
- Built the financial models the roadmap runs on: cohort churn, acquisition cost ceilings, operating costs by phase, sales team pay and a path to $1M in monthly revenue
- Built the new landing pages (one per trader skill level, plus checkout) and the full Meta Pixel + Conversions API tracking spec for the dev team; designed the member referral program

Founder, VELARE (first brand)

Aug 2024 – July 2025

- Started at 16 with no audience. First drop sold 2 of 100 units (my mom and a friend). Grew to about $100K in year one
- Survived $30K of inventory stuck in customs, then relaunched as v2byVELARE at 6x the monthly revenue

things i built

Self-taught with Python and AI coding tools (Claude Code) since January 2026. 12 projects, 40K+ lines of code.

- **Content engine:** an AI system that learns what makes short-form video spread, then makes it. Tracks every one of my 800+ reels live through the official Instagram API and, with a partner, 104K+ posts across 403 brands. Writes, voices and edits new videos, with a panel of AI viewers grading every cut before it posts. Where it's going: organic content you can optimize for reach, clicks or sales the way Meta optimizes ads
- **Drop Gate:** virtual queue so drops never crash. Load-tested to 2,583 shoppers at once, 0 failures, $5/month server
- **Cash Deck:** the system I run v2's money on. Syncs 44K+ Shopify Payments transactions, simulates cash week by week, and sizes every production order to the cash we'll have
- **Quant research:** backtester to catch fake edges (blind holdouts, real costs, preset kill rules), ~210K ideas screened
- **AI operating system:** 13 always-on agents and a 590+ note knowledge base that rank new revenue moves nightly

other

- Started Execution Group, a 250+ member community of young brand founders, and wrote a 71-video founder course
- Spoke at NYU Stern (Sep 2025) on using AI in startup marketing
- Paid model and creator for 12+ streetwear brands; organized a group popup during NYFW (Feb 2026)
- Given away $57K+ in clothing (about 800 pieces), 250+ to shelters and youth programs
- Irvington High School, June 2026. Admitted to Northeastern. Varsity soccer 4 yrs, piano 10 yrs, fluent Spanish